provisions of ***World Trade Organisation*** so as to face the challenges of agriculture sector. This policy gives emphasis on promoting agricultural exports after fulfilling domestic demand. The salient features[46] of this policy are:

- Four per cent growth rate p.a. for the next two decades.
- Four per cent growth rate p.a. target to be achieved by 2005.
- Land reforms to provide land to poor farmers.
- Consolidation of holding in all states of the nation.
- Promoting private investments in agriculture.
- To provide insurance umberalla for crops to farmers.
- To promote bio-technology.
- Promoting research for developing new varieties and ensuring protection to the developed varieties.

AGRICULTURAL INSURANCE

There are various major crop insurance schemes under implementation in the country:

(i) *National Agricultural Insurance Scheme (NAIS):* The NAIS is a government-sponsored central-sector crop insurance scheme being implemented in the country since 1999-2000 season (the erstwhile *Comprehensive Crop Insurance Scheme-CCIS* of 1985 was merged into it) with the **objective** of providing financial support to farmers in the event of failure of crops as a result of *natural calamities, pests, and diseases.* The Agriculture Insurance Company of India Ltd. (AICIL) is the implementing agency for the Scheme. At present, the scheme is being implemented by 25 states and two UTs[47].

(ii) *Modified NAIS (MNAIS):* With the aim of further improving crop insurance schemes, the MNAIS is under implementation on **pilot basis** in 50 districts in the country from rabi 2010-11 season. Some of the major improvements made in the MNAIS are[48]–